

Benedict Pabatao

STAFF SOFTWARE ENGINEER, PLATFORM & PRODUCT | AWS | TERRAFORM | AGENTIC TOOLING

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SUMMARY

Staff Software Engineer - I build the platform other engineers ship on. 8+ years in software, 5+ on AWS, 3+ years on a multi-tenant SaaS platform behind 7 live utility client portals, now its most senior hands-on engineer. Primary author of the Terraform control-plane the fleet is migrating onto (93%) and of both generations of its core REST API (58% of v1, serving six of them; 76% of v2, serving the seventh since June 2026 and beside v1 for the first migration). Also its operator: CI/CD, observability, incident response, security remediation and cost.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Staff Software Engineer, Platform & Product

ESC Partners / HometownHUB (contract) - New York, USA (Remote) | May 2023 – Present

Current title: Sep 2025 – Present | Previously Senior Full-Stack Engineer (Cloud): May 2023 – Aug 2025

- **Primary author of both generations of the fleet's core REST API** - 58% of v1, serving six of seven launched tenants, and 76% of v2 (Fastify, TypeScript, Zod, MongoDB on ECS Fargate), serving the seventh since June 2026 and beside v1 for the first migration - owning their shared auth, data-access and Oracle CCS (OAuth 2.0) patterns.
- **Primary author (93%) of the internal developer platform:** a Terraform control-plane (9 stacks, ~60 AWS resource types - Cognito, ECS Fargate, CloudFront, WAFv2, Secrets Manager, Route 53, ElastiCache, KMS) with a Fastify/React dashboard that plans, applies and cost-attributes; the fleet's per-portal provisioning is consolidating onto it tenant by tenant.
- **Most senior hands-on engineer on a small product team; primary platform engineer** for the 11-tenant prod and test fleet (7 live) - set standards (13 accepted ADRs, provisioning modules, CI/CD, security guardrails, pre-push/pipeline gates); run Bitbucket Pipelines, CloudWatch, incident response, Cost Explorer attribution, shared ALB, test-fleet Fargate Spot.
- **Ran the remediation program for 6 external pentest rounds** - triaged 60 findings into severity-labelled batches (IDOR, unauthenticated endpoints, URL-borne tokens, client-side privilege checks, missing rate limits).
- **Shipped the fix for an SSN identity-verification gap enabling account takeover** - the last-four plus street match resolved to the wrong person on ~2.4% of one tenant's accounts - as attempt lockout plus ZIP-based disambiguation, flag-gated for per-tenant rollout.
- **Faster, stricter delivery** - core API CI ~12 to ~7 min (esbuild, cache-mounted installs, fail-fast), admin portal ~10 to ~6 min (April 2026), plus blocking Snyk gates (newer portals, both APIs) and keyless OIDC deploys on 4 repos.
- **Sole author of the observability/accountability layer** - provider-call capture (redacted on v2), tiered audit retention, account-to-IP anomaly view, takeover alert; a composite index cut the sessions view 102s to 2.4s (43x).
- **Built and pruned the team's AI tooling** - kept a Claude PR reviewer in CI across the API and portal repos, shelved a Bedrock auto-remediation service after 12 of 13 runs failed, shipped a Bedrock knowledge-base agent (curated-first retrieval, flagged SQL fallback), and designed a ticket-to-PR pipeline with human gates, not yet live.
- **Built a runtime feature-flag platform** - MongoDB-backed reader replacing build-time env vars, wired into 6 v1 admin consoles and 4 portals, enabled per tenant.
- **Own the CCS/Invoice Cloud reconciler** - detection-only by default, guarded repair - that replaced the batch sync I switched off.

Senior Full Stack Engineer

Nmblr - Biopharma Strategy & Collaboration Platform (contract) - London, UK (Remote) | Mar 2024 – Present

- One of 3 core engineers on an ISO 27001-certified biopharma strategy SaaS (React/TypeScript, Node/GraphQL/Prisma, AWS Elastic Beanstalk), reporting to the CEO; private beta with enterprise pharma clients.
- **Originated two subsystems from scratch:** a DMMF-driven strategy clone engine (automated deep-clone of entire strategies) and the Edge archive/restore isolation system.
- **Serialized concurrent writes and killed data races:** wrapped rating upserts in a transaction behind a Postgres advisory lock (`pg_advisory_xact_lock`) and fixed a duplicate-row race in a GraphQL sync resolver.
- **Built the in-house observability layer:** an Apollo plugin emitting one structured `obs_event` per GraphQL operation to CloudWatch, an `errClass` fault/reject/noise scheme, staging and production dashboards, Beanstalk logs streamed to CloudWatch, Sentry hardened (tunnel, sourcemaps, gated replay) - then removed New Relic.
- **Built AI Context Configuration** - a per-strategy assistant response mode only a non-external strategy lead can choose - plus a Notion-backed assistant knowledge base and AI-endpoint hardening; contributed to real-time collaboration (GraphQL subscriptions), OpenAI-backed generation and platform security (OWASP/IDOR, JWT sessions).

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer - CoDev - agency; embedded with client BaseMap (Utah, USA / Remote) |

Mar 2022 – May 2023 (JavaScript, Docker)

Full Stack Software Engineer - Ordermentum (NSW, Australia / Remote, contract) | Sep 2022 – Mar 2023 (Node.js, PostgreSQL, Docker, Kubernetes)

Senior Software Engineer II - HCL Technologies (New York, USA / Remote) | Feb 2020 – Apr 2022 (Kubernetes, Selenium)

Full Stack Developer - Zencomputes (Singapore) | Mar 2019 – Feb 2020 (React, Node.js, AWS Elastic Beanstalk)

Mobile Application Developer - Halcyon Digital Media Design (Philippines) | Mar 2018 – Mar 2019 (Ionic)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CLOUD & INFRA: AWS - ECS Fargate, Lambda, CloudFront, Cognito, DynamoDB, EventBridge, ElastiCache, Secrets Manager, WAFv2, SES, S3, Route 53, VPC, ALB, IAM, Elastic Beanstalk, Terraform, Docker, Linux

PLATFORM & DEVOPS: Internal Developer Platform, Multi-tenant provisioning, Bitbucket Pipelines, GitHub Actions, FinOps - Cost Explorer

AI ON THE PLATFORM: AWS Bedrock (Claude), AI code review in CI, LLM knowledge bases (RAG), Evaluating and pruning AI tooling

BACKEND & DATA: Node.js - Fastify, Express, TypeScript, Python, REST APIs, GraphQL, Prisma, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Zod, Vitest, Playwright, Oracle Utilities CCS, Invoice Cloud

OBSERVABILITY & SECURITY: Datadog RUM/APM, CloudWatch, CloudWatch Synthetics, Sentry, Structured logging, Session Replay, OWASP/IDOR, JWT, OAuth 2.0, OIDC, IAM, WAFv2, Snyk, Pentest remediation

FRONTEND: React, Next.js, TypeScript, MUI, Styled Components, Tailwind, React Native (Expo), Accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA)

PRACTICES: Platform Engineering, Infrastructure-as-Code (IaC), System Design & Architecture, Security & Compliance, Incident Response

EDUCATION

BS Information Technology

Polytechnic University of the Philippines | 2014 – 2018